MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including the last two focused mostly on CI/CD pipelines, test environments and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams and has built short-lived Kubernetes test environments with Helm. Personal infrastructure projects include a k3s cluster deployed with GitOps, monitoring and logging, and Terraform-provisioned infrastructure for a Hetzner VPS. Seeking to move into a DevOps or platform engineering role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure and delivery: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Terraform (personal project)
Kubernetes and GitOps: Kubernetes (namespace-level access and Helm test environments at work); k3s and Argo CD (personal project)
Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki; Grafana dashboards for test metrics
Programming and data: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, PostgreSQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Systems: Linux, Git; AWS EC2 and S3 basics (personal learning)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; reduced monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request test environments with Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster; environments run end-to-end tests and are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for seeding PostgreSQL test data and created Grafana dashboards for flaky-test metrics.
- Wrote the internal guide to how CI works, which is used in team onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw | 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Selenium and Java automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024–2025

- Operated a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, deploying applications from a Git repository with Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring and logging, with Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health | 2023–2024

- Enabled each merge request to receive a short-lived environment for the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, deployed via Helm from GitLab CI to the shared Kubernetes cluster.

- Configured automatic cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity; QA and product teams use the environments to review features before merge and run end-to-end tests.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATION AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Studying for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA); exam booked for January 2027.

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)